

FAMILY CUP SPORTS ACTIVITY OVERVIEW

General Concept

The activities are designed to promote teamwork, communication, cooperation and a positive family experience rather than to focus solely on physical strength or speed. Many activities include age and gender-based starting positions or progressive difficulty adjustments to help balance differences in physical ability. Teams are encouraged to communicate, develop their own strategy and support one another. In some activities, success also depends partly on luck. The main goal is to enjoy the experience together while strengthening communication and cooperation within the family.

Scoring System

- The programme consists of 11 team stations and 1 individual station, for a total of 12 stations.
- At team stations, the team's result is determined by finishing time. Teams are ranked from fastest to slowest.
- The team in 1st place receives 1 point, the team in 2nd place receives 2 points, and so on. Therefore, the lower the total score, the better the overall result.
- In the event of a tie, all teams sharing a position receive the points corresponding to that position. The subsequent rank is skipped accordingly. For example, if three teams share 3rd place, all three receive 3 points and the next team is ranked 6th and receives 6 points.
- The individual station awards bonus points to the relevant teams based on the best individual performances in six age/gender categories. A bonus of 1–3 points may be used depending on the number of participating teams; fewer bonus points are recommended when there are fewer teams so that the bonus does not disproportionately influence the overall result.

General Safety Rule

Safety takes priority at every station. Participants must follow the instructions of the activity supervisor. Whenever balls, rings or other objects are being thrown or moved through the activity area, no participant may enter the active throwing or movement zone until it is safe to do so.

1. LASER BIATHLON

Objective

Complete a four-person relay consisting of five target shots per participant followed by a designated running distance.

To arrange the activity you will need:

- Laser rifle and electronic target system (original set-up).
- Cones or other markers for three distances.
- Timer.
- Alternative equipment: safe ball-based target equipment suitable for the venue.

How to prepare the activity

Set up three distances: the closest for children up to and including age 7, the middle distance for women/girls, and the furthest distance for men/boys. In the original version, use a laser rifle and electronic target system. Because this equipment is specialised, an alternative version should be prepared for locations where it is not available.



Rules

Each of the four participants completes five shots, then runs their designated distance and hands the relay over to the next participant. Every missed shot adds 10 seconds to the team's total time. There is no additional penalty lap for a missed shot. The final result is the total elapsed time including all penalty seconds.

Difficulty / time adjustments

The running distance may be adapted to the age group. For children up to and including age 7, the running section may be omitted so that they only complete the target element before handing over the relay.

Notes

The laser version requires appropriate equipment, supervision and safe operation. For wider public use, a simple alternative using readily available materials is recommended. Most materials for the alternative can be sourced from an ordinary hardware/building-supply store.

2. RINGO FLAMINGO

Objective

Throw plastic rings onto the necks of three flamingo figures and successfully place seven rings as quickly as possible.

To arrange the activity you will need:

- 3 plastic flamingo garden figures.
- 20 plastic rings, approximately 20 cm in diameter.
- Equipment to get stabilize flamingo garden figures (this time is used flowerpot and sand inside)
- Cones or other markers for three throwing lines.
- Timer.

How to prepare the activity

Place the three flamingos in one line into flowerpot and cover flamingo legs with sand. Mark three throwing lines approximately 2 m, 3 m and 4 m from the flamingos. The closest line is for children up to and including age 7, the middle line for women/girls, and the furthest line for men/boys.

Rules

After the start signal, the team throws the rings. Any flamingo may be used; the seven successful rings may be distributed across any of the three flamingos. Team members may decide who throws and who collects the rings. Once the available rings have been thrown, participants collect them and return to the throwing lines. Stop the time when seven rings are successfully on the flamingo necks.

Difficulty / time adjustments

If the task is not completed within 1 minute, move the women/girls to the children's line and the men/boys to the women/girls' line. Children remain at their original line. After 2 minutes, all participants may throw from the closest line.



Notes

The required number of successful rings may be adjusted to suit the venue and desired difficulty.

3. OBSTACLE COURSE

Objective

Two team members must cross an obstacle course as quickly as possible while relying on verbal guidance from their teammates.

To arrange the activity you will need:

- Two parallel corridors, approximately 1.5 m wide and 4 m long each.
- Water bottles (suggest using 500-750 ml) placed randomly inside the corridors; 7 per corridor is recommended.
- Start and finish floor markers.
- Blindfolds or suitable eye coverings.
- Timer.

How to prepare the activity

Set up two parallel corridors. Place the water bottles randomly inside each corridor. Clearly mark the start and finish of the course. Prepare eye coverings. You can use paper towels on eyes and adding diving glasses on top.

Rules

Two participants enter the corridors on all fours with their vision fully blocked. Each blind participant is guided by one teammate (if in team is 3 participants, one person guides 2 blind ones) using voice instructions only. The guide may not touch the participant. The blind participant must remain inside the designated corridor. Stop the time when the second participant has completely crossed the finish line.



Difficulty / time adjustments

Add 20 seconds for every water bottle knocked over. If a participant leaves the corridor, add 20 seconds and the participant must return to the course before continuing.

Notes

The course must be checked for hazards before every session. Guides may use only verbal instructions. The activity should be closely supervised.

4. BALL PATH

Objective

Move a ball from a starting recess to a finishing recess on a specially designed board as quickly as possible.

To arrange the activity you will need:

- A specially designed ball-path board holes and raised barriers.
- Four ropes with loops, approximately 50 cm long, attached to the board corners.
- One table-tennis ball.
- One tennis ball for the second difficulty level.
- A finish gate positioned beyond the finishing recess.
- Timer.



How to prepare the activity

Place the board so that each participant can control one corner using the rope loop. The board should contain a starting recess, finishing recess, holes and raised barriers. The edges are not enclosed, so the ball may fall from the board.

Rules

After the start signal, the team works together to move the ball from the starting recess to the finishing recess by carefully tilting the board. If the ball falls through a hole or over the edge, restart from the starting recess. Participants must communicate and coordinate their movements. If in team is 3 participants, one holds 2 ropes.

Difficulty / time adjustments

If the table-tennis ball has not reached the finish within 1 minute, replace it with a tennis ball and continue without resetting the overall time. If the task is still not completed after 2 minutes, use the finish gate beyond the finishing recess as the target and remove the requirement for precise placement in the finishing recess. The time continues throughout.

Notes

Children up to and including age 7 may hold the board directly at their corner instead of using the rope loop. If there are fewer than four participants, participants may control more than one corner.

4. BASKETBALL SHOTS

Objective

Score one successful shot in each of five different basketball hoops as quickly as possible.

To arrange the activity you will need:

- A board/stand with five basketball hoops: 3 smaller and 2 larger.
- A net attached to each hoop (with closed ending that balls are not dropping through).
- Approximately 7 basketball balls of different sizes.
- Cones or other markers for three throwing lines.
- Timer.



How to prepare the activity

Mount five hoops on one board/stand. Attach a net to each hoop so that a successful shot remains visibly identifiable. Mark three throwing lines approximately 2 m, 3 m and 4 m from the target. The closest line is for children up to and including age 7, the middle line for women/girls, and the furthest line for men/boys.

Rules

After the start signal, team members throw the balls and collect them only when it is safe. The objective is to score at least one successful shot in each of the five different hoops. Multiple shots may go into the same hoop, but only one successful shot per hoop counts. Stop the time when all five hoops have received at least one successful shot.

Difficulty / time adjustments

After 1 minute, move the women/girls to the children's line and the men/boys to the women/girls' line. Children remain at their original line. After 2 minutes, all participants may throw from the closest line.

Notes

A mixture of ball sizes encourages the team to choose its own strategy. No one may enter the throwing area while balls are being thrown.

5. BALL KNOCKDOWN

Objective

Knockdown all water bottles as quickly as possible by throwing balls from the designated lines.

To arrange the activity you will need:

- At least 5 water bottles (500 ml); 7 is recommended.
- At least 5 stands/platforms of different heights; one bottle per stand.
- Approximately 10 balls of different sizes and weights.
- Cones or other markers for three throwing lines.
- One bucket or container for collecting the balls.
- Timer.

How to prepare the activity

Arrange the stands in an approximately 3 × 4 m area, with the 4 m side facing the participants. Place one water bottle on each stand. Mark three throwing lines approximately 3 m, 4 m and 5 m from the nearest stands. The closest line is for children up to and including age 7, the middle line for women/girls, and the furthest line for men/boys.



Rules

After the start signal, participants throw the balls at the bottles. Initially all balls stand in basket. In this exercise all team members can participate also in case they are more than 4. The team may decide who throws and who collects the balls, as well all can throw and collect. Once all balls have been thrown, one or more team members collect them and return them to the bucket. Continue until all bottles have been knocked down. Stop the time when the last bottle falls.

Difficulty / time adjustments

If the task is not completed within 1 minute, move the women/girls to the children's line and the men/boys to the women/girls' line. Children remain at their original line. If the task is still not completed after 2 minutes, all participants may throw from the closest line.

Notes

Use a mixture of ball sizes and weights. Only a small proportion (approximately 2–3 out of 10) should be large/heavy balls that make knocking down the bottles easier. No one may collect balls while throwing is in progress

7. LADDER GOLF

Objective

Score at least five points using golf ball bolas as quickly as possible.

To arrange the activity you will need:

- One ladder-golf stand with three horizontal rungs.
- 8 bolas (a rope with a golf ball tied to each end)
- (2 per participant in a four-person team).
- Cones or other markers for three throwing lines.
- Timer

How to prepare the activity

Set up the ladder-golf stand with three rungs. The top rung is worth 3 points, the middle rung 2 points and the bottom rung 1 point. Mark three throwing lines for children up to and including age 7, women/girls and men/boys

Rules

After the start signal, participants throw their bolas from their designated lines. The team may decide which members throw. Participants throw one after another. Once all bolas have been thrown, participants collect them and return to the throwing lines. Continue until the team has scored at least 5 points. Stop the time when the team reaches at least 5 points after the relevant throwing cycle.

Difficulty / time adjustments

For safety, no one may collect bolas while another participant is throwing. All



participants must remain behind the throwing lines until throwing has stopped.

Notes

The team may choose to have only one participant throw while others collect and return the bolas, or divide the throwing between several participants.

8. DUCK RACE

Objective

Move a floating duck from one end of a water-filled channel to the other and back to the starting position using air only.

To arrange the activity you will need:

- A water channel/gutter approximately 3 m long with both ends closed.
- A stable stand/support for water channel.
- Water to fill the channel.
- 1 small yellow floating duck to fit to water channel.
- 4 hand-operated air pumps or air-blowing water pistols.
- Timer.

How to prepare the activity

Place the approximately 3 m channel securely on its stand and fill it with water. Place the duck at the starting wall. Two participants stand at each end of the channel.

Rules

After the start signal, the first two participants use air to push the duck toward the opposite end. They must not touch the duck. When the duck touches the opposite wall, the first pair stops and the other pair begins pushing it back. Stop the time when the duck returns to the starting wall.



Difficulty / time adjustments

If the duck has not returned within 2 minutes, all four participants may use their air pumps to help move it.

Notes

Use air only; the pumps should not spray water. The channel must be stable, and any spilled water must be removed immediately to prevent slipping.

9. CUBE PUZZLE

Objective

Assemble a large picture puzzle as quickly as possible.

To arrange the activity you will need:

- A 3 × 3 cube puzzle consisting of 9 large cubes, approximately 50 × 50 × 50 cm each.
- A reference image/design.
- Alternatively, a conventional jigsaw puzzle of approximately 30 pieces.
- Timer.

How to prepare the activity

Mix the nine cubes and place them at the starting area. Use the designated reference image/design to determine which picture the team must assemble. The team may assemble the picture on the floor, table or another suitable surface.



Rules

After the start signal, the team identifies the required picture and works together to assemble the nine cubes into the correct image. The cubes may be arranged horizontally or vertically; the final image must be correct. Stop the time when the complete picture is correctly assembled. All teams participate as well in cases team size is larger than 4.

Difficulty / time adjustments

There is no specific age-based simplification. The main challenge is visual recognition, problem-solving, communication and speed.

Notes

If the specialised cube puzzle is unavailable, use a conventional jigsaw puzzle. The number of pieces can be adjusted to achieve a similar level of difficulty.

10. RECYCLING GAME

Objective

Sort all waste-item tokens into the correct waste categories as quickly as possible.

To arrange the activity you will need:

- 6 waste-category containers, boxes or buckets.
- 5 tokens representing each category (30 tokens recommended).
- Printed waste symbols/labels
- Board
- A table or other flat surface.
- Timer.

How to prepare the activity

Arrange the six labelled containers. Place all 30 waste tokens freely on the table before the start. Each token should display a clear waste symbol. The six categories should reflect the recycling system used in the country or event location. Prepare board where to stick picture of correct order.



Rules

After the start signal, the team sorts all tokens into the correct containers. After 1 minute, one participant may move to a position where they can see the correct sorting arrangement but cannot see exactly what the other participants are doing. This participant may give verbal instructions but may not point to individual tokens. After 2 minutes, the participant may stand and provide more precise visual guidance. All teams participate as well in cases team size is larger than 4.

Difficulty / time adjustments

The containers must be stable and the symbols easy to understand. A simple alternative to the specialised game is to use ordinary boxes or buckets with printed waste-category symbols attached to them.

Notes

The exact six categories should be adapted to the local waste-sorting system. The activity can therefore be used in different European countries while retaining the same basic concept.

11. MOVING SPOONS

Objective

Transfer a ball through four vertically arranged spoons and finally into a bucket as quickly as possible.

To arrange the activity you will need:

- A specially designed vertical spoon stand with 4 spoon positions.
- 4 large spoons, one for each participant.
- 1 table-tennis ball.
- 1 tennis ball for the second difficulty level.
- A small bucket below the final spoon.
- A cover/top section that limits the view during the first stage.
- Timer.

How to prepare the activity

Set up four spoons vertically from bottom to top, with the spoon positions staggered. The upper cover should limit the participants' view from above. Place the bucket below the final spoon. Start with the table-tennis ball in the lowest spoon.



Rules

After the start signal, participants work together to transfer the ball from one spoon to the next without touching the ball with their hands. Each participant controls their assigned spoon. The ball must travel through all four spoons and then be dropped into the bucket. If there are fewer than four participants, one participant may control two spoons. If in the team is children till 7 years old, team starts task with tennis ball.

Difficulty / time adjustments

If the ball has not reached the bucket within 1 minute, replace the table-tennis ball with a tennis ball and continue without resetting the time. If the task is still not completed after 2 minutes, remove the cover so participants can see the arrangement from above and give clearer instructions. The time continues throughout.

Notes

The stand should be stable and the spoons securely fixed. Participants should coordinate their movements and communicate continuously.

12. BLOW CHALLENGE

Objective

Blow a table-tennis ball as far as possible along a sloped track. This is the individual bonus station.

To arrange the activity you will need:

- A specially designed track/channel approximately 3 m long.
- A stable stand supporting the track at approximately 30–40°.
- Table-tennis balls.
- Distance markings along the track.
- Six category markers.
- Measuring method or distance scale.

How to prepare the activity

Create six categories: boys aged 0–7, girls aged 0–7, boys aged 8–13, girls aged 8–13, men aged 14+, and women aged 14+. Set the track securely at approximately 30–40°. Each participant uses the section/position designated for their category.

Rules

Place the table-tennis ball at the lower starting point. The participant approaches the track and blows the ball, without touching it, to move it as far as possible along the track. Each participant has 3 attempts. Measure the furthest distance achieved. The best result from the three attempts counts.



Difficulty / time adjustments

The participant with the best result in each category earns the designated bonus points for their team. The number of bonus points should be selected according to the number of participating teams; 1–3 points are recommended.

Notes

The angle may be adjusted to change the difficulty. An angle of approximately 30–40° is recommended; angles above 45° are not recommended because the track is already long and the ball can move quickly.